

My (Chiffon) Nguyen

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Current and future AI that are socially responsible and beneficial for diverse groups of humans and social contexts

- **AI alignment** (value alignment, pluralistic alignment, OOD generalization, multi-agent systems)
- **multilingual and multicultural AI**, focusing on language, speech, and vision-language models
- **human-AI collaboration & socially aware AI** grounded in social science, Human-Computer Interaction research

EDUCATION

Minerva University, College of Computational Sciences

Sep 2021 – May 2025

B.Sc in Computational Sciences (Machine Learning and Statistics), GPA: 3.7/4.0

San Francisco, CA, USA

- **Relevant Coursework:** Machine Learning (A), Bayesian Modeling (A), Statistical Modeling and Causal Inference (A), Optimization Methods (A), Probability and Statistics (A-)
- **Global Experience:** Seoul (South Korea), Taipei, Hyderabad (India), Buenos Aires (Argentina), Berlin (Germany)

SELECTED PUBLICATION

P=Preprint, R=Under Review, J=Journal, C=Conference, W=Workshop. Full publication list on [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=MyChiffon).

- [R1] **SEATauBench: Adapting Tool-Agent-User Evaluation Into Low-Resource Southeast Asian Languages**
My Chiffon Nguyen*, Aulia Adila*, Saksorn Ruangtanusak*, Kittiphath Leesombatwathana*, Vissuta Gunawan Lim*, Patomporn Payoungkhamdee, Samuel Cahyawijaya
In submission for EMNLP, 2026.

- [P1] [Anthropogenic Regional Adaptation in Multimodal Vision-Language Model](#)
Samuel Cahyawijaya, Peerat Limkonchotiawat, Tack Hwa Wong, et al. (including My Chiffon Nguyen)
Preprint, 2026.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Analysis Subteam Lead (Cultural Reasoning Evaluation)

May 2026 – Present

Cohere Labs Community

Remote

AI Research Mentee (Multilingual Agentic Evaluation)

Feb 2026 – Expected Jun 2026

SEACrowd, SEACrowd 2026 Research Apprenticeship

Remote

- Stress-testing [Tau2-Bench](#), which benchmarks Tool-Agent-User interaction in real-world domains, across shifts in language and local cultural contexts
- Mentors: [Dr. Samuel Cahyawijaya](#) (Cohere Labs) and [Patomporn Payoungkhamdee](#) (VISTEC Thailand)

AI Research Lead Mentee (Scalable Oversight & Chain-of-thought Monitoring) Oct 2025 – Expected Jun 2026

AlgoVerse AI Research, AI Research Program Fall 2025 (Mentor: [Yeonwoo Jang \(MATS 8.2\)](#))

Remote

- Investigating whether weaker AI models can detect [sandbagging](#) (deliberate underperformance) in stronger models on safety-critical evaluations. [\[Code\]](#)
- Designed end-to-end monitoring pipeline (Inspect AI + Inspect Scout) and evaluated monitoring success rates across 30+ pairs of reasoning models (Qwen3.5, Deepseek V4, Gemma4, GPT-OSS)

Machine Learning Research Assistant (3D Object Detection Application)

Jun – Aug 2024

Landshut University of Applied Sciences, AI & Mixed Reality Lab

Landshut, Bavaria, Germany

- Supervisors: [Prof. Eduard Kromer](#) and [Prof. Sandra Eisenreich](#)

TEACHING & MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Curious Cardinals, *AI & Data Science*, Mentor

Nov 2025 – Present

- Mentoring a project about robustness of fact-checking language models under evidence corruption and language shifts

Minerva University, *PR51 Programming with Python*, Lead Tutor

Spring 2025

- Taught 40+ first-year students from 20+ countries in **weekly hands-on programming labs** for 11 weeks, covering Python, OOP, debugging, security, and computing fundamentals
- Analyzed student performance data and tutor surveys across 11 weeks to identify 12 learning bottlenecks, improving engagement metrics by 15% for the next cohort

Minerva University, *FA50/FA51 Logic, Probability & Statistics*, Lead Teaching Assistant

Fall 2022 – Spring 2024

- Supported **150+ students each semester** per semester in formal logic, probability and statistics, algorithmic thinking, and simulation, through weekly office hours
- Provided **formative assessment on 25 semesterly quizzes** for 50 students to correct and shape their learning
- Assisted professors in **grading** three semesterly math and programming assignments

SELECTED PROJECTS

Mnemonic Generation for Vocabulary Learning (github.com/mychiffonn/mnemonic-gen) Oct 2024 – Present

- Designed an AI chatbot that generated diverse, memorable, and linguistically-grounded mnemonic devices for learning English and Mandarin Chinese vocabulary
- Utilized chain-of-thought distillation from a teacher model (DeepSeekR1) to instill linguistic chain-of-thought reasoning to a student model (Gemma3-1b) through **supervised fine-tuning (QLoRA)** with unsloth
- Implemented a **Direct Preference Optimization (DPO)** pipeline through trl for preference modeling on Gemma3-1b using 500 human and LLM-annotated preference pairs (on memorability, imageability, and retention rates)

Replication: Synthetic Control (Causal Inference) (github.com/mychiffonn/synthetic-control-rep) Dec 2023

- Replicated [Chrisinger \(2021\)](#)'s synthetic control analysis of Philadelphia's SNAP benefit redemption in R, analyzing policy impacts across 4 counties and 50+ months of longitudinal data
- Extended analysis with leave-one-out robustness analysis, revealing original donor pool sensitivity and model instability

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

[SEACrowd Website](#) Engineer & Maintainer

Aug 2025 – Present

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, SQL, Bash, TypeScript, R
- **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, scikit-learn, unsloth, trl, Inspect AI, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, harbor, benchflow
- **Web/App Development:** Astro, React, FastAPI, Express.js, PostgreSQL, TailwindCSS, shadcn/ui
- **Tools & DevOps:** Git, Docker, Python tooling (uv, ruff, ty), LaTeX, Zotero

LANGUAGES

Vietnamese (native), English (fluent/C1), Mandarin Chinese (lower-intermediate/B1/HSK 4)

CERTIFICATES

- **Tiny Aya Expedition**, Cohere Labs (credsverse.com/credentials/0e262642-a662-4d2b-ac4e-8ca35fc2f80c) Mar 2026
- **Advanced Web Development**, CodePath (drive.google.com/file/d/1n4dHj4TFM8HWIDXMTt9ZGjEXVIpkP-F-/view)
- **Natural Language Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/3FJ3W7QJX8GK) Nov 2023
- **Machine Learning Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/G9898XKB9EAV) Jun 2022

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